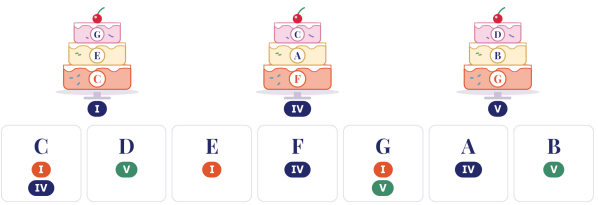
HARMONY · CHORDS UNDER A MELODY · LEARN

Chords under a melody



REMEMBER Look at the main notes of each bar (strong beats, long notes) and pick the cake that holds them: I, IV or V.

1 Which cake holds it?

★☆☆

In C major: write I, IV or V for each note. C and G live in two. The first is done.

NOTE	C	D	E	F	G	A	B
Chord	**I, IV**						

2 Pick the chord

★☆☆

Each bar is in C major. Circle the cake that holds its notes. The first is done.

C E G E	**(I)** · IV · V
F A C A	I · IV · V
G B D B	I · IV · V
E C E G	I · IV · V
D B G B	I · IV · V

3 The three cakes of G major

★★☆

Write the notes of I, IV and V in G major (one sharp: F♯). The first is done.

CHORD	NOTES
I (G)	**G B D**
IV (C)	
V (D)	

4 Pick the chord in G

★★☆

Each bar is in G major. Circle the cake that holds its notes. The first is done.

G B D B	I · IV · V
C E G E	I · IV · V
D F♯ A F♯	I · IV · V
B G B D	I · IV · V

Date _____

HARMONY · CHORDS UNDER A MELODY · USE

Chords under a melody

REMEMBER Alberti bass: low, high, middle, high. On C: C G E G.

1 Chords for Mary Had a Little Lamb ★★☆

Write I or V under each bar (in C major). If the notes disagree, pick the cake that holds most of them. The first is done.

Bar	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Tune	E D C D	E E E	D D D	E G G	E D C D	E E E E	D D E D	C
Chord	I							

2 Write the Alberti bass ★★☆

Low, high, middle, high: write the four notes for each chord. The first is done.

CHORD	NOTES	ALBERTI
C	C E G	C G E G
F	F A C	
G	G B D	

3 Write the broken chord ★★☆

Low, middle, high, middle: write the four notes for each chord. The first is done.

CHORD	BROKEN
C	C E G E
F	
G	
Am	

4 Play it ★☆☆

Right hand: the tune. Left hand: the chords (block, then broken, then Alberti). Tick a circle each clean day.

Mary, block chords ○ ○ ○ ○

Mary, broken chords ○ ○ ○ ○

Mary, Alberti bass ○ ○ ○ ○

Twinkle, Alberti bass ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____